

# The B2B SaaS Homepage Audit

10 Parameters + Scorecard  
(all you need to fix your homepage)

## 10 Audit Parameters

1. Category Clarity
2. ICP Specificity
3. Problem Framing
4. Value Proposition Clarity
5. Differentiation
6. Hero Section Coherence
7. Messaging Hierarchy & Page Flow
8. Social Proof Quality
9. Competitive Positioning Awareness
10. Conversion Architecture

## Scorecard

| #     | Parameter                 | Audit question                                                                          | Score (X/5) | Gap diagnosis |
|-------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|
| 1     | Category clarity          | Does the page name a recognisable product category within the first 5 seconds?          |             |               |
| 2     | ICP specificity           | Does the hero section signal clearly who this product is for?                           |             |               |
| 3     | Problem framing           | Is the buyer's specific problem and their current inadequate solution acknowledged?     |             |               |
| 4     | Value proposition clarity | Is there a clear capability → outcome link that a buyer can immediately understand?     |             |               |
| 5     | Differentiation           | Does the page articulate what makes this product different from realistic alternatives? |             |               |
| 6     | Hero section coherence    | Do headline, subheadline, visual, and CTA work together as a system?                    |             |               |
| 7     | Messaging hierarchy       | Does the page flow as a persuasion sequence: Problem → Product → Proof → Action?        |             |               |
| 8     | Social proof quality      | Is proof specific, credible, and targeted at the real objections of a Series A buyer?   |             |               |
| 9     | Competitive positioning   | Does the page speak to a buyer who is already evaluating alternatives?                  |             |               |
| 10    | Conversion architecture   | Is the primary CTA clear, stage-appropriate, and frictionless?                          |             |               |
| Total |                           |                                                                                         | XX/50       |               |



# Parameter 1: Category Clarity

The question being answered: "What is this product?"

This is the first thing a visitor's brain tries to find answer to. If they can't place the product in a mental category within first 5 seconds, they leave, not because they're uninterested, but because the cognitive load is too high.

## What to look for:

- Does the hero headline or sub-headline name a recognisable product category? (e.g., "revenue intelligence platform", "AP automation software")
- Does the category language match how buyers actually search and describe the problem or is it some internally invented category name/jargon?
- Is the category claim too broad ("AI-powered platform for teams") or too narrow ("Jira automation for fintech ops teams with 500+ engineers")?

## Scoring guide:

- 5: Category is named explicitly, matches buyer language, is appropriately scoped
- 4: Category is implied but requires a sentence of reading to confirm
- 3: Category is buried in a subheadline or requires scrolling
- 2: Category is replaced by a vague aspiration ("the future of work" type language)
- 1: No category signal at all and the page reads like internal documentation

## Failure pattern:

Founder-written headlines that lead with the company's unique methodology rather than the category (e.g. "The Compound Growth Operating System" instead of "Revenue Analytics Software").

Fill your Score :



## Parameter 2: ICP Specificity

The question being answered: "Is this for me?"

B2B buyers do an instant self-qualification check. If the page doesn't signal who it's for within the first scroll, the right person leaves. They simply assume it's not for them.

### What to look for:

- Is there an explicit signal of who this is for? (Persona, company type, industry, team size, or use case context)
- Is the ICP defined by behaviour/context or just firmographics? ("For RevOps teams running multi-channel outbound" is better than "For B2B companies")
- Does the ICP signal appear in the hero, or is it buried in a "who it's for" section three scrolls down?

### Scoring guide:

- 5: ICP is clear in the hero - persona, context, or use case is explicit
- 4: ICP is identifiable within the first scroll, but relies on inference
- 3: ICP is named somewhere on the page but the hero is generic
- 2: ICP is implied only through the features listed, not stated
- 1: Page could be for anyone with no qualification signals

### Failure pattern:

Mostly horizontal products that are afraid to exclude anyone, so they speak to everyone and resonate with nobody. The fix isn't niching down the overall product but to choose which use case to lead with on the homepage.

Fill your Score :



## Parameter 3: Problem Framing

The question being answered: "Do they understand what I'm dealing with?"

This is the empathy parameter. Buyers don't buy products but exits from their existing problems. If the homepage doesn't demonstrate that the company understands the problem from the buyer's perspective, everything else (features, benefits, proof) just doesn't land.

### What to look for:

- Is the problem stated from the buyer's point of view, or the seller's?
- Does the problem framing describe a specific situation or pain, or is it generic ("teams struggle with collaboration")?
- Is the "current way" i.e. how buyers solve this problem today without the product, acknowledged?
- Does the page explain why the current way is inadequate?

### Scoring guide:

- 5: Specific, buyer-language problem with the current-way failure clearly named
- 4: Problem is present and directionally right, but framed in seller language
- 3: Problem is implied through feature descriptions, not stated directly
- 2: Problem framing is so generic it applies to 50 other categories
- 1: No problem framing. Jumps straight to features or aspirational outcomes

### Failure pattern:

"Your team deserves better" kinda copy that names no specific problem. Or leading with the problem from a market-level ("\$X billion is wasted annually") rather than the individual buyer's day-to-day struggle and reality.

Fill your Score :



## Parameter 4: Value Proposition Clarity

The question being answered: "What specifically do I get and why should I want it?"

This is distinct from category and problem framing. The value proposition is the bridge between the problem you've named, here's what the product actually does about it and what that means for the buyer's world.

### What to look for:

- Is there a clear articulation of what the product does (capability) and not just what outcomes it promises?
- Does the value proposition connect a specific capability to a specific outcome in one logical step?
- Is the promised outcome something the ICP actually cares about, or a second-order benefit they'll have to work backwards from?
- Does the homepage "sell the drill" (what the product is and does) before it sells the "quarter-inch hole" (the outcome)? Benefits without capabilities are unconvincing.

### Scoring guide:

- 5: Capability + first-order outcome clearly stated and buyer can immediately visualise the result
- 4: Good outcome framing but the capability that produces it is vague
- 3: Either only features (no outcome) or only outcomes (no capability)
- 2: Value proposition is a generic claim ("save time, reduce costs") with no specificity
- 1: No coherent value proposition with page being a list of features or a mission statement

### Failure pattern:

"Increase revenue by X%" claims with no explanation of how. Or capability-only pages (feature dumps) with no articulation of what changes in the buyer's day.

Fill your Score :



# Parameter 5: Differentiation

The question being answered: "Why this over everything else I could use?"

This is the most commonly skipped parameter at Series A companies. They assume the visitor knows the competitive landscape, or they're afraid of naming alternatives. The result: messaging sounds identical to three other direct competitors.

## What to look for:

- Does the page articulate what makes this product different from alternatives and not just what it does?
- Are the stated differentiators genuine and specific (a feature, a methodology, a data advantage), or generic claims ("easy to use", "built for enterprise")?
- Does the page acknowledge what the competitor set is (named tools, spreadsheets, manual processes)?
- Is differentiation present in the hero, or buried in a comparison table two-thirds down?

## Scoring guide:

- 5: Specific, credible differentiator named and substantiated in the hero or first scroll
- 4: Differentiator is present but stated as a claim without proof
- 3: Differentiator is implied by a comparison table lower on the page
- 2: "Easy to use / powerful / flexible" type language which doesn't differentiate from anything in a meaningful way
- 1: No differentiation signal at all. Page could be lifted and placed on a competitor's site and yet nothing changes.

## Failure pattern:

Pages that list features instead of differentiators. Being feature-complete is not a differentiator, it's at times baseline expectation. The differentiator is the specific thing a competitor can't or won't do.

Fill your Score :



# Parameter 6: Hero Section Coherence

The question being answered: "Does the hero-page elements work as a system?"

The hero section (headline, sub-headline, visual, and primary CTA) is the single highest-leverage piece of real estate on a homepage. These four elements need to work together, not independently. Most hero sections have each of these element optimised separately and the whole is incoherent.

## What to look for:

- **Headline:** Does it carry a clear message, or is it a tagline/slogan that sacrifices clarity for cleverness?
- **Sub-headline:** Does it complete, extend, or add specificity to the headline or simply repeat it in different or more words?
- **Visual:** Is it a product screenshot/demo that adds information or a stock illustration/abstract graphic that adds nothing?
- **CTA:** Does the CTA text reflect where the visitor is in their journey (early-stage research vs. ready to buy), or is it a generic "Get Started"?
- Does the above-the-fold section answer at least "what is it" and "is it for me" without scrolling?

## Scoring guide:

- 5: All four elements work as a system. Above-the-fold answers what + who it's for without scrolling
- 4: Three of four elements strong; minor gap in coherence
- 3: Hero contains the right elements but they feel assembled independently
- 2: Hero leads with brand/aspiration language that delays value communication
- 1: Hero is a full screen image, video background, or slogan with no informational content

## Failure pattern:

"Headline is the vision, sub-headline is the tagline, visual is a gradient with floating UI elements, CTA says 'Get Started'."

Fill your Score :





# Parameter 7: Messaging Hierarchy & Page Flow

The question being answered: "Does the page make logical sense while scrolling and answer my next probable question"

Individual sections can be strong while the overall page is incoherent. Messaging hierarchy is about whether the page is structured as a persuasion sequence or just a collection of sections that someone thought were important.

## What to look for:

- Does the page follow a logical sequence: problem acknowledgment → capability/product → proof → differentiation → conversion?
- Are there abrupt topic shifts or “Hey, look how great we are” sections that break the visitor's thinking?
- Does the page tell you what to pay attention to at each stage or do all sections feel equal in weight?
- Is the page length appropriate? Too short loses persuasive power; too long loses attention.

## Scoring guide:

- 5: Clear persuasion sequence, each section builds on the last with appropriate lengths
- 4: Right sections present but sequencing is slightly off (e.g., proof before problem)
- 3: Sections feel modular and interchangeable with no narrative thread
- 2: Page jumps between topics without connection and sections feel independently designed
- 1: No discernible structure. Page is either a feature dump or an about-us page

## Failure pattern:

Social proof (customer logos) appearing before the problem or value proposition has been established. Logos before a visitor knows what you do create no impact since the visitor hasn't decided if they care yet or not.

Fill your Score :





## Parameter 8: Social Proof Quality

The question being answered: "Can I trust that this works for someone like me?"

Social proof at Series A is almost always present but rarely doing real work. The question is not "do they have testimonials" but "are the testimonials doing the job of reducing the specific doubts a buyer has at this stage?"

### What to look for:

- Are testimonials specific (named person, company, outcome) or generic claims?
- Do testimonials address the specific objections a Series A buyer has (implementation risk, ROI, switching cost)?
- Are customer logos representative of the ICP or a mix of logos thrown together for brand recognition?
- Is there third-party validation (G2 ratings, analyst mentions, press) or only first-party claims?
- Are the numbers cited (customers, ARR, outcomes) specific and credible or round, vague, and unprovable?

### Scoring guide:

- 5: Specific testimonials with named outcomes, logos match ICP, third-party validation present
- 4: Testimonials are specific but don't address key objections; logos are right audience
- 3: Testimonials are generic but present; logos are recognisable but not ICP matched
- 2: Only logos, no testimonials; or testimonials with no names/outcomes
- 1: No social proof, or social proof that raises more questions than it answers

### Failure pattern:

Five enterprise logos from the pilot cohort that don't represent the ICP, paired with three testimonials that say "intuitive interface" and "great customer support."

Fill your Score :



# Parameter 9: Competitive Positioning Awareness

The question being answered: "Does the company know who they're competing with and does the page reflect that?"

This is a PMM-specific parameter that auditors often miss. A homepage can have clear messaging, good proof, and strong CTAs and still lose deals because it doesn't address the competitive context the buyer is already in. By the time a Series A buyer visits your homepage, they've usually already visited two or three competitors.

## What to look for:

- Does the page acknowledge what alternatives exist (competitors/ incumbent tools/ manual processes)?
- If a comparison page or "vs" section exists, is it genuinely differentiating or just a green-checkmarks table?
- Does the page speak to a buyer who is already evaluating alternatives and not just a first-time category discoverer?

## Scoring guide:

- 5: Competitive context explicitly addressed, differentiation from alternatives is substantiated
- 4: Competitive awareness implied through positioning choices; comparison page exists and is useful
- 3: Comparison section present but generic and competitive context not visible in hero
- 2: Page assumes no competition and doesn't acknowledge alternatives exist
- 1: Page actively avoids competitive context; positioning could apply to any player in the category

## Failure pattern:

Pages that list capabilities without ever acknowledging what the buyer is currently using. "We do X" without "better than Y" is an incomplete message for a buyer who's already comparing.

Fill your Score :



# Parameter 10: Conversion Architecture

The question being answered: "Is the path from interest to action clear, frictionless, and appropriately matched to where the buyer is?"

This is the only parameter that touches execution over messaging but it's critical from a PMM lens. CTA language, placement, and friction are messaging decisions, not just design decisions.

## What to look for:

- Is there a single, clear primary CTA or multiple competing actions that create paralysis?
- Does the CTA language reflect the buyer's journey stage? ("See how it works" or "Book a 20-min walkthrough" is better than "Get Started" for a cold visitor)
- Is there a secondary CTA for the not-yet-ready visitor (e.g., read a case study, watch a demo)?
- Are there friction-reducers near the primary CTA? (No credit card required, 14-day trial, cancel anytime)
- Is the primary CTA accessible across the full page and not just above the fold?

## Scoring guide:

- 5: Single primary CTA with buyer-stage appropriate language, friction reducers present, secondary CTA for earlier-stage visitors
- 4: Good CTA language but missing friction reducers or secondary path
- 3: CTA present but generic ("Get Started", "Sign Up"). These CTAs match no specific stage
- 2: Multiple CTAs creating confusion in the visitor's mind.
- 1: No clear CTA or CTA leads to a high-friction form with no value exchange

## Failure pattern:

"Book a Demo" as the only CTA on the page, with no secondary option for visitors who aren't ready to talk to sales yet. You've built a page that only converts the 5% who are ready to buy and loses the 95% who aren't. Your page should engage the 95% also.

Fill your Score :



# Scoring Interpretation

Now, sum total all the scores across the 10 parameters. Check which score category your product falls into.

| Category   | Total Score | Diagnosis                                                                              |
|------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Category 1 | 40–50       | Solid foundations - Optimisation opportunity                                           |
| Category 2 | 30–39       | Mixed - Some strong sections masking critical gaps                                     |
| Category 3 | 20–29       | Significant messaging confusion - Your visitor exits website with unanswered questions |
| Category 4 | Below 20    | Foundational positioning problem - Page is symptom, not cause                          |

If you fall under Category 2,3 and 4.

I can help!

I work with \$1M to \$5M ARR B2B SaaS startups to build product marketing from scratch i.e. positioning strategy, website homepage, and sales enablement.

Engagement duration - 4-6 weeks

If this resonates, [Let's talk](#)

And for more such content, connect with me on [LinkedIn](#)

Cheers,  
Arpit

